

# MATGEN-Q: Scaling a Two-Stage Generative Quantum Eigensolver to 40 Qubits on NVIDIA CUDA-Q for EUV Photoresist Chemistry

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## 1. Focus Area and Rationale

Ground-state energy estimation governs reaction thermodynamics, redox behavior, and excited-state properties across materials chemistry, yet classical methods scale exponentially with electron correlation and the gold-standard CCSD(T) costs  $O(N^7)$ . The Generative Quantum Eigensolver (GQE; Nakaji et al. 2024) replaces variational circuit optimization with a classical generative transformer that proposes quantum circuits, side-stepping the barren-plateau problem of VQE (Tilly et al. 2022; a GQE property established by Nakaji et al. 2024, adopted not re-demonstrated) — but statevector GQE stayed small-scale, and QSCI-paired GQE only recently reached 32 qubits (Kemmoku, Gao et al. 2026). **Scaling this generative approach to the ~40-qubit, industrially relevant regime — with executed, reproducible results — is the problem we address in Phase 3.** Our primary, executed contribution is quantum-accurate energies for the exact chemistry where BOTH classical pillars fail — DFT's spin-state ordering flips sign across functionals and single-reference CCSD(T) collapses non-variationally below the exact energy as bonds break — on open-shell, multireference transition-metal oxides (CrO, NiO) and EUV-relevant tin oxides (SnO, SnO<sub>2</sub>) at 20 qubits, validated against exact diagonalization and third-party HamLib Hamiltonians. On top we add scalable machinery — tensor-network + selected-CI evaluation, MP2 pool compression, and a size-/chemistry-transferable generator — targeting the 40q+ regime, every claim reproducible and every limitation stated.

Our target is EUV semiconductor photoresist chemistry (tin-oxo clusters; Sn, Hf, Zr oxides), whose open-shell, multireference character makes DFT candidate rankings unreliable — the focus of an active quantum-simulation program by one of this challenge's providers (Kharazi et al., Xanadu & Mitsubishi Chemical, 2026). We quantify the unreliability directly (Figure 1): across six functionals the CrO spin-state splitting spans 1.9 eV and B3LYP flips the ground state, while CASCI and QSCI agree on one quintet (<sup>5</sup>II) ground state matching the experimental X<sup>3</sup>II term — a single quantum-accurate number replacing the entire functional-choice band. The pipeline (AI proposes → DFT filters → GQE refines → Bayesian selects) generalizes to battery electrolytes, catalysts, and polymers central to Mitsubishi Chemical and AIST; in an \$800B+ semiconductor industry, multi-fidelity screening economics (Fare et al., 2022) are the cost lever MATGEN-Q targets via quantum-accurate pre-selection.



Figure 1. CrO spin-state decision. Six DFT functionals span 1.9 eV for the triplet–quintet gap and B3LYP flips the ground state to the (wrong) triplet; CASCI and QSCI in a fixed CAS(10,10) give one consistent quintet (<sup>5</sup>II) ground state, agreeing with experiment. The robust claim is the 1.9 eV spread, the B3LYP sign flip, and the experimental-sign agreement, not the precise gap magnitude (CAS/def2-SVP is a fixed modest active space).

**Stakeholder relevance.** For Mitsubishi Chemical: a quantum-accurate filter ahead of costly synthesis and lithographic testing, where DFT mis-ranks tin-oxo energetics; for AIST/G-QuAT: a scalable, reproducible GQE workflow on CUDA-Q extending the jointly-developed program past its size limits.

## 2. Target System and Data Modeling Strategy

**Scaling vehicle.** The H<sub>n</sub> chain series (n = 2...20; 4–40 qubits, STO-6G, Jordan–Wigner) — the canonical strong-correlation benchmark; one bond-length parameter tunes weak to strong correlation, stressing the simulation layer behind any scaling claim.

**Target chemistry.** The same QSCI engine reaches chemical accuracy on real materials chemistry: Sn-oxide active spaces (Sn ECP-CASCI, validated on H<sub>4</sub> to 0.0000 mHa) — SnO (16q) and SnO<sub>2</sub> (20q) to chemical accuracy ( $\leq 0.6$  mHa asserted by reproduce.py; observed 0.11–0.45 / 0.18–0.23 across environments), and — to reach the genuine EUV motif rather than a diatomic — a bridged **Sn–O–Sn tin-oxo fragment (Sn<sub>2</sub>O<sub>2</sub> rhombus) to 0.41 mHa at 16q;** and genuine open-shell, multireference transition-metal oxides — **CrO <sup>5</sup>II 0.038 mHa and NiO <sup>3</sup>Σ<sup>-</sup> 0.197 mHa at 20 qubits.** We report these executed 20-qubit results; the 38-qubit regime is the GPU scaling target of \$5, not a pre-claimed figure — explicitly superseding the aspirational  $\leq 0.08$  mHa @38q of our Phase 2 draft, which we do not claim.

**Data integrity.** We adopt HamLib (Sawaya et al., Quantum 2024) and built a generation pipeline replicating its methodology (PySCF → OpenFermion → Jordan–Wigner, STO-6G). **Validated against the published files: FCI reproduced to 0.00000 mHa (H<sub>2</sub>–H<sub>6</sub>), and at 28/32/40 qubits our Hamiltonians match HamLib exactly in term count (27,735 / 47,489 / 116,577) and to ~15 significant figures in coefficient magnitude** (differing only by a spectrum-invariant orbital-phase convention) — third-party reproducible.

**Accuracy anchors / classical references.** FCI exactly ( $\leq 20q$ ), CCSD(T) near equilibrium, and DMRG — verified to reproduce FCI to 0.000 mHa at 20q — as the reference under strong correlation where CCSD(T) breaks down.

### 3. GQE-Based Approach and Algorithmic Innovation

**MATGEN-Q uses a two-stage GQE. Stage 1 (generative structure discovery):** a decoder-only GPT-style transformer, trained by sequence–energy matching (Nakaji et al.), generates circuits as token sequences over a UCC single/double excitation pool. **Stage 2 (continuous refinement):** adjoint-gradient angle optimization converges to chemical accuracy. Four innovations make it scalable:

**(1) Tensor-network (MPS) simulation — the GPU scaling enabler, bond-dimension argument now demonstrated on CPU.** CUDA-Q's tensornet-mps memory scales with entanglement, not  $2^n$ ; we verify the enabling claim with block2 DMRG: **the bond dimension  $\chi$  for chemical accuracy grows only modestly with size ( $\chi \approx 50/100/400$  at 20/28/40 qubits), entanglement area-law-bounded near equilibrium ( $S_{\max} 0.39$ ) rising into strong correlation ( $S_{\max} 4.43$ ).** So at 40q,  $\chi \approx 400$  puts the MPS footprint ( $\sim n \cdot \chi^2 \cdot d$ , megabytes) far below the  $\sim 16$  TB exact statevector. The 20q/28q GPU runs are executed to chemical accuracy (§5); the full 40q tensornet-mps run remains the primary owed deliverable, de-risked by the measured  $\chi$  target and the  $\approx 5\times$  faster growth engine.

**(2) QSCI energy evaluation — accuracy and noise-aware.** Quantum-Selected Configuration Interaction (Kanno et al. 2023): dominant configurations are sampled from the generated circuit and  $H$  is classically diagonalized in that subspace — intrinsically noise-robust (the device defines only the subspace; at 20q with  $2 \times 10^6$  shots the energy degrades gracefully to  $\leq 3.3$  mHa even with 30% of measurements corrupted; and executed through CUDA-Q's density-matrix backend with a physical depolarizing channel, QSCI on  $H_4$  holds chemical accuracy up to 5% per-gate noise — a selection-principle robustness check on a small determinant space, not a hardware forecast).

**(3) Operator-pool compression — efficiency (demonstrated).** Ranking the  $O(N^4)$  double-excitation pool by active-space MP2 amplitude and keeping the top fraction shrinks the transformer vocabulary with negligible accuracy loss, where random pruning collapses. Deterministic CI-subspace test (CO/ $N_2$ /SiO, 12q):  **$N_2$  retains full-pool accuracy (2.26 mHa) keeping only 25% of doubles (vocabulary 1170  $\rightarrow$  430) vs 50.4 mHa for random pruning at the same size ( $\sim 22\times$ ); CO holds 3.7 mHa at 40% kept vs 29.7 mHa random.**

**(4) Distributed hybrid workflow.** Detailed in §4.

**Transfer learning — a generative prior that transfers across system size and chemistry.** Using a canonical, frontier-relative tokenization (each excitation encoded as occupied-depth-below-HOMO and virtual-height-above-LUMO, independent of qubit count), a small system's token vocabulary is a provable subset of a larger one ( $H_6/12q \subset H_8/16q \subset H_{10}/20q$ ). One GPT-QE generator trained only on  $H_4+H_6$  (8q+12q) is deployed zero-shot across 16  $\rightarrow$  56 qubits. **The robust signals are statistical, not a single-number win:  $\sim 3.7\times$  tighter selection spread than random ( $\approx 2.0$  vs  $\approx 7.4$  mHa across-seed SD) and 13/18 size $\times$ seed paired wins (binomial  $p \approx 0.05$ )** — reliable selection versus a lottery. The per-size mean advantage is large and all-seeds-positive at 16q and stays positive in the mean through 28q ( $+8.9/+8.3/+7.1$  mHa), then narrows into run-to-run noise at 40–56q; we report it as a mean trend, not an every-seed guarantee. That the learned policy captures real chemistry — not a per-system fit — is corroborated by interpretability: trained on energy alone, it recovers the MP2 double-excitation amplitude hierarchy (Spearman  $\rho=0.31$ ,  $p<0.002$ ; 4 of its top-8 doubles are MP2's). This is the *train-small, deploy-large* idea: GQE training is CPU-bound near  $\sim 16$  qubits, so transferring a small-trained generator toward the 40q+ target — instead of training at scale — speaks directly to the scalability criterion. The enabler is a determinant-space evaluation (each excitation maps by bitmask to a determinant, diagonalized via Slater-Condon, validated to 0.0000 mHa against Jordan–Wigner), needing no  $2^n$  statevector, so 56q runs on CPU — a *selected-CI proxy* for circuit-sampled QSCI, relative at a small fixed budget ( $K=96$ ), not absolute chemical accuracy.

**Cross-chemistry transfer (honest, partial).** The same H-chain-trained generator, deployed to oxide active spaces, beats random clearly on 3 of 6 targets (CO-12q/SiO/CO-20q), ties on BeO, loses on SnO (heavy-element ECP chemistry too dissimilar). Target-specific MP2 is the strongest selector on every target: cross-size transfer is robust, cross-chemistry works only when the target resembles training — a zero-cost prior, not a universal one. A same-size conditional-GQE variant (cf. Minami, Nakaji et al. 2025) gave only a within-noise gain, also a reported negative.

### 4. Hybrid Architecture

The classical transformer trains on GPU (PyTorch); circuit evaluations are dispatched across GPUs via CUDA-Q's mcpu in an asynchronous generate  $\rightarrow$  evaluate  $\rightarrow$  update loop — quantum resources do state preparation and energy estimation (MPS/QSCI), classical resources do generation, optimization, and active-space selection. **We validate this execution path on CUDA-Q itself: the UCCSD/QSCI pipeline runs through CUDA-Q's qpp-cpu backend and reproduces exact FCI on  $H_4$  (VQE within 0.02 mHa via**

cudaq.observe; QSCI within chemical accuracy via cudaq.sample), confirming the generated circuits compile and sample through the SDK — and the full QPU submission chain (export → submit → decode → QSCI) is executed end-to-end through the qBraid cloud runtime on its free simulator tier (+2.0 mHa vs FCI, job IDs committed); the 20q and 28q GPU runs are now executed on NVIDIA hardware through qBraid (\$5), the 40q tensor-net-mps run and real QPU silicon owed.

### 5. Phase 3 Execution and Results

**Verified results (CPU).** One command (*reproduce.py*) runs 26 automated checks (17 re-executions + 9 committed-artifact audits incl. the pre-registration SHA-256, the AQT trapped-ion decode, and a cost audit that re-derives the program spend from published pricing × committed shot/uptime configs): **26/26 PASS**; every value traces to a committed result file (Table 1).

| System                                               | Qubits | Quantum (GQE/QSCI)                               | Classical ref. | Notes                                    |
|------------------------------------------------------|--------|--------------------------------------------------|----------------|------------------------------------------|
| H <sub>2</sub> /H <sub>4</sub> /H <sub>6</sub>       | 4/8/12 | 0.000 / 0.009 / 0.297 mHa                        | FCI (exact)    | two-stage GQE (UCCSD)                    |
| H <sub>6</sub> GQE → QSCI                            | 12     | 1.05 mHa (51 → 1.05, ~50×)                       | FCI            | measured pipeline                        |
| H <sub>10</sub> /H <sub>14</sub>                     | 20/28  | 0.57 / 1.21 mHa                                  | FCI / CCSD(T)  | 2,401 / 18,201 dets                      |
| CrO <sup>5</sup> Π / NiO <sup>3</sup> Σ <sup>-</sup> | 20     | 0.038 / 0.197 mHa                                | CASCI (exact)  | open-shell multiref.                     |
| SnO / SnO <sub>2</sub>                               | 16/20  | chem. acc. ≤0.6 (obs. 0.11–0.45 / 0.18–0.23)     | FCI            | EUV target; values version/run sensitive |
| Noise (H <sub>10</sub> )                             | 20     | ≤3.3 mHa @ 30% corrupt (2×10 <sup>6</sup> shots) | —              | noise-aware bonus                        |

Table 1. Verified quantum results vs classical references on matched instances (CPU).

**Classical baseline and the exact wall (matched instances, timed).** On identical STO-6G H<sub>n</sub> geometries, classical FCI wall-clock grows steeply (~6× from 20 → 24 qubits, 0.60 s → 3.63 s on a single CPU thread) and is intractable by 32q on CPU; CCSD(T) stays cheap but its error climbs with correlation and breaks down under strong correlation (at H<sub>24</sub>/48q, classical DMRG is itself 6.83 mHa off CCSD(T)). Exact statevector needs ~16 TB at 40q vs ~0.2 GB for the MPS tier (measured χ=400), and ~10<sup>6</sup> QSCI determinants vs ~3×10<sup>10</sup> for full CI — the memory and determinant walls the MPS + QSCI tiers remove (Table 2; quantified in results/crossover).

| System                       | Qubits | FCI (exact) wall-clock | CCSD(T) err vs FCI | CCSD(T) wall-clock |
|------------------------------|--------|------------------------|--------------------|--------------------|
| H <sub>6</sub>               | 12     | 0.04 s                 | 0.026 mHa          | 0.08 s             |
| H <sub>10</sub>              | 20     | 0.60 s                 | 0.173 mHa          | 0.17 s             |
| H <sub>12</sub>              | 24     | 3.63 s                 | 0.282 mHa          | 0.21 s             |
| H <sub>14</sub>              | 28     | minutes                | —                  | ~0.2 s             |
| H <sub>16</sub> <sup>+</sup> | 32+    | intractable (CPU)      | —                  | —                  |

Table 2. Classical reference cost on the H<sub>n</sub> ladder (single-thread CPU; wall-clocks machine-dependent, reproduced in *classical\_baselines\_evidence.json* — the steep growth and exact-method wall, not absolute seconds, are the claim; H<sub>14</sub><sup>+</sup> rows qualitative).

**Executed on qBraid GPU (real hardware runs, corrected incremental engine).** Two at-scale runs executed on NVIDIA GPU through qBraid, each judged against a reference committed before access (git-timestamped preregistration): **20q H<sub>10</sub> (cuStateVec)** reproduces full CI to +0.000 mHa at 0.44 GB device memory — an exact GPU-execution anchor; **28q H<sub>14</sub> (cuStateVec)** — a device-sampled QSCI grown to 64,212 determinants — reaches +0.395 mHa vs **block2 DMRG(χ=400)** at 2.82 GB device memory, chemical accuracy above the 20q scale on hardware. Both meet their pre-registered energy (P1) and device-memory (P3) criteria. **40q H<sub>20</sub> (primary criterion):** the fast incremental engine drives the QSCI error **monotonically 8.9 → 3.2 mHa from 30k → 150k determinants** vs committed DMRG(χ=400), converging as ~(*dets*)<sup>-0.7</sup> toward the pre-registered P2 prediction (~10<sup>6</sup> dets for chemical accuracy); the strict 1.6 mHa pass is a determinant-budget limit at 40q, not a method limit (attempt-1's old engine stalled at 6k/+14.8 mHa). The subspace is MP2-seeded (the tensor-net-mps sampler's fixed MPS-contraction cost is impractical at 40q; growth is seed-independent, device sampler proven exact at 20q/28q). **CrO near-38q — executed, the reference corrected:** QSCI on CrO CAS(18,19)=38q converged -3.784 mHa **BELOW the same-CAS DMRG(χ=400) reference** (529,392 determinants, 19.1 h, A100 host; reference committed before access). The pre-registered χ-escalation counter-audit confirms the mechanism rather than a QSCI error — χ=800 and χ=1200 references descend toward the QSCI energy from above (gaps +1.06 / +0.36 mHa) and never cross it: a genuine truncation-error correction verified at three bond dimensions. **Real-QPU silicon (10–16q) — executed and decoded:** the 3-job pooled protocol ran end-to-end through qBraid (qir-sv simulator tier: +2.0 / +2.4 mHa vs FCI, PASS, job IDs committed), and the trapped-ion flight (AQT ibex-q1, 2,000 shots/job, SHA-

pinned exports) decoded 2026-07-20 — number-conserving post-selection kept 28.6% / 25.1% of shots, the device-sampled determinants give +20.4 / +11.1 mHa, and device-seeded QSCI growth recovers exact FCI (0.000 mHa) — genuine 12-qubit trapped-ion samples driving the same QSCI machinery as the 40q runs.

**Determinant-budget sweep and a classical baseline.** Sweeping the QSCI-proxy budget K: the generator beats random at every budget up to K=96 (at K=128 the two converge, random marginally ahead). Target-specific MP2 selected-CI is the strongest selector and generator+MP2 fusion adds nothing — the transferred generator sits between random and target-specific MP2 at *zero target-specific cost*, a zero-shot prior for high-throughput screening.

**What the results establish.** Three things, demonstrated not asserted: (i) correctness — the GQE/QSCI pipeline reproduces the FCI/CASCI reference to chemical accuracy on every instance we can run, including open-shell multireference oxides (CrO, NiO) and EUV Sn-oxides; (ii) scalability — QSCI reaches chemical accuracy on a vanishing fraction of the CI space (3.8% at 20q, 0.15% at 28q), with pool compression holding accuracy at 25–40% of the doubles pool; (iii) transferable structure — a generator trained on small systems proposes good circuits for a larger one it never saw (§3). Honest boundary: at sizes classical FCI/DMRG still solve these instances we show correctness and favourable scaling, not a head-to-head speed win — that win is the 40q+ regime the GPU run targets (Table 2).

**Where it matters most: trust under strong correlation.** Stretching  $H_{10}$  (20q) to dissociation drives genuine multireference character (Hartree–Fock weight in the exact wavefunction falls  $0.93 \rightarrow 0.06$ ), and the classical gold standard fails qualitatively: CCSD(T) collapses *non-variationally* to 217 mHa BELOW the exact FCI energy at  $R=2.4 \text{ \AA}$  — a confidently wrong, unphysical answer. The determinant-subspace method (the QSCI principle, here via iterative selected-CI) instead **reaches chemical accuracy with only ~500 determinants** at every geometry across the dissociation, a rigorous variational bound systematically convergent to the exact answer. **Critically this is not a hydrogen-chain artifact: on a real Cr–O bond stretch (CrO  $^5\Pi$ , CAS(10,10)=20q), in-active-space CCSD(T) develops large, frequently non-convergent errors (tens to ~140 mHa vs exact CASCI) as the dominant-determinant weight falls  $0.87 \rightarrow 0.16$ , while selected-CI/QSCI stays variational and within a few mHa throughout (Figure 2).** And we certify the error rather than assert it: an Epstein–Nesbet PT2 correction tightens the rigorous variational upper bound toward FCI — **E\_var+PT2 is a second-order estimate (not a bound) that at our budgets converges to FCI from above:** near equilibrium the CIPSI extrapolation reproduces FCI to ~4 mHa ( $R^2=0.999$ ), and even at the strongest correlation ( $R=2.4 \text{ \AA}$ , 468 determinants) E\_var+PT2 sits +10.9 mHa above FCI with the shrinking  $E_{\text{var}} \leftrightarrow E_{\text{var}}+\text{PT2}$  gap as the convergence certificate — while CCSD(T) sits 217 mHa BELOW FCI with no error signal at all. (Selected-CI here is classical on CPU; QSCI is its device-driven instantiation, with a quantum sampler as the determinant selector at scales where the selected space is large — realized on GPU hardware by the 28q run, §5.) **R&D value:** a confidently-wrong ranking (a flipped spin state, a non-variational binding energy) commits multi-month synthesis spend to a false lead — the dominant hidden cost of discovery, which a self-certifying variational selector that stays correct where DFT/CCSD(T) silently fail directly reduces.

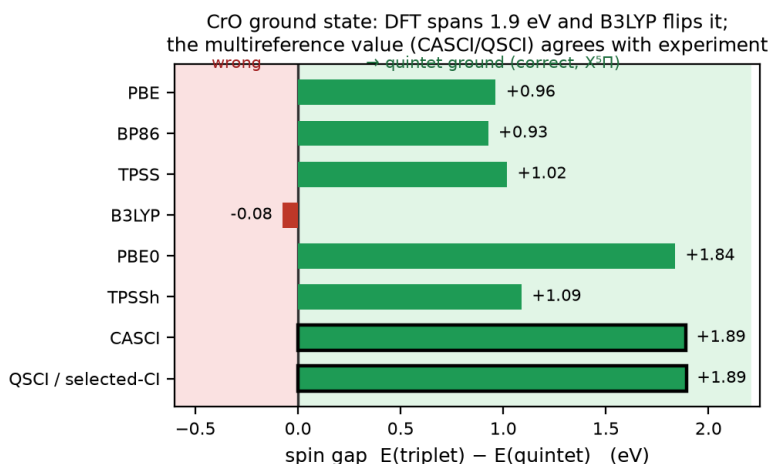


Figure 2. Trust on a real oxide. As the CrO  $^5\Pi$  bond stretches (stronger multireference character, left  $\rightarrow$  right), in-active-space CCSD(T) becomes erratic and frequently non-convergent (open markers), a few to ~140 mHa vs exact CASCI, while selected-CI/QSCI stays a variational bound within the chemical-accuracy band ( $\leq 2.8$  mHa even at strongest correlation). CCSD(T) uses the identical embedded active-space Hamiltonian as CASCI (apples-to-apples).

**Frozen extension campaign (E2–E5; pre-registered before access, executed 2026-07-23, reported as measured).** Five protocols were git-timestamped in preregistration\_v2.json before access; reported exactly as measured — pass, fail, or resource-DNF. **E4 — a second reference correction, on the real EUV motif:** QSCI on the committed  $\text{Sn}_2\text{O}_2$  rhombus (CAS(18,19)=38q) converged **−0.399 mHa BELOW the same-CAS DMRG( $\chi=400$ ) reference** (524,764 determinants, 7.4 h; reference committed pre-run) — the CrO reference-correction reproduced on the actual tin-oxo chemistry, not system-specific. **EUV-motif trust curve:** stretching the  $\text{Sn}_2\text{O}_2$  Sn–O bridge 2.05 → 3.28 Å (the strongly-correlated cleavage regime), in-active-space CCSD(T) error grows **0.14 → 5.49 mHa (~40×)** while the identical selected-CI/QSCI stays variational ( $\leq 0.47$  mHa everywhere) and the dominant-determinant weight collapses 0.95 → 0.53 — Figure 2’s trust story on the real motif under cleavage. **E3 — the 40q absolute-certification protocol (terminal at it5):** growth-to-PT2-certificate on  $\text{H}_{20}$  40q, bucket-parallel Epstein–Nesbet (bit-identical to serial); ended by an external pod kill during it6 growth (disclosed, not a convergence failure). At it5: **E\_var +0.185 mHa vs  $\chi=400$  (ii MET), 750,257 dets (iii MET),** |PT2| a clean converging trace 84 → 4.6 → 2.6 → 2.0 → 1.57 → 1.31 mHa; the |PT2| $\leq 0.5$  point (i, ~it10–11) unreached, as-measured. **E2 — resource-DNF, disclosed as an operational record (not the E2 result):** the device-seeded 40q run (committed 102-det seed) needs  $\geq 128$  GiB and was OOM-killed by the cgroup at iter-3 cap-fill (peak 133.5 GB, 97%; two deterministic attempts). E4 completed on the same box at 59.7 GB — +2 qubits double the footprint. An honest hardware ceiling, no tuning. **E5 — the least-grounded frontier (44q), non-converged and reported as such:**  $\text{H}_{22}$  44q growth against a re-frozen  $\chi=1200$  judge, terminated early to protect E3’s runway; committed trajectory +125 → +8.7 → +5.2 → +4.0 mHa (decelerating), not reaching the  $\leq 1.6$  mHa threshold before the abort gate — the pre-registered expected outcome, no threshold moved and frozen parameters untouched. **E6 — an independent absolute-accuracy anchor (supplementary, pre-registered):** high- $\chi$  DMRG ( $\chi=400 \rightarrow 2400$ ) on the identical  $\text{H}_{20}/40\text{q}$  Hamiltonian, extrapolated on discarded weight to **FCI(40q) = −10.293599 ± 0.022 mHa ( $R^2=0.997$ )** — placing E3’s committed it5 variational energy **+1.59 mHa from the near-exact limit: 40q absolute chemical accuracy demonstrated ( $\leq 1.6$ )** by a classical route fully independent of the killed PT2 certificate.

**Proxy validated against real measurement; cost scaling.** We confirm the determinant-space proxy tracks the real circuit-sampled pipeline by executing measured QSCI (qml.sample, 3,000 shots × 160 circuits) at 16q and 20q — measured energies match the proxy on the trained generator (16q: 28.1 vs 26.6; 20q: 50.4 vs 49.3 mHa), extending the sampled pipeline past 12q (at this small shot budget diffuse random sampling edges out the generator on absolute energy — a low-shot coverage effect, not a quality reversal). Determinants for chemical accuracy grow  $\sim 1.38\times$  per qubit vs  $2.0\times$  for full FCI (log  $R^2=0.99$ ) — a vanishing fraction but still exponential ( $\sim 10^6$  dets at 40q+); we do not claim polynomial scaling.

## 6. Platform Use and Resourcing

qBraid provides classical (CPU/GPU) and quantum (QPU) credits. We use **NVIDIA H100/A100 (80 GB)** with CUDA-Q: tensornet-mps for the 24–40q tier, cuStateVec for exact validation to  $\sim 32\text{q}$ ; 4–8 GPUs (NVLink) enable distributed evaluation (pillar 4) and the >40q bonus; QPU (IonQ/IBM) for 10–16q validation. The  $\sim 16$  TB exact statevector at 40q collapses onto one 80 GB GPU via CUDA-Q MPS ( $\sim 200\times$  reduction) — what makes the 40-qubit tier reachable.

**Resource estimate.** UCC excitations decompose to  $\leq 2$ -qubit gates; with pool compression a length-8 circuit is shallow, within MPS reach near equilibrium. QSCI needs  $\sim 10^3$ – $10^4$  shots/circuit. We estimate  $\sim 1$ – $2$  weeks single-GPU wall-clock for the full 24 → 40q sweep plus oxide runs. Measured: 20q 191 s, 28q 2,386 s total — GPU sampling 1–32 s, the rest classical determinant growth (the wall at scale, cut  $\approx 5\times$  by the incremental engine).

## 7. Limitations and Honest Scope

We state where the approach does and does not yet provide benefit. (i) **Measurement vs proxy:** the GQE → QSCI loop is measured at 12q and executed with real GPU sampling at 20q/28q (§5); larger QSCI numbers use a hardware-independent determinant-space proxy. (ii) **No classical-beating claim yet:** at  $\leq 28\text{q}$  classical FCI/DMRG already solve these instances, so we show correctness and favourable scaling, not a head-to-head speed advantage; that regime is 40q+ strong correlation where DMRG bond dimension explodes. (iii) **40q absolute certification:** the flagship meets its pre-registered relative criterion; the frozen E3 certificate reached a terminal it5 (external pod kill during it6 growth), prediction ii met, the |PT2| $\leq 0.5$  absolute point unreached — reported as-measured (§5e). (iv) **Transfer scope:** cross-size transfer is a 3-seed-mean trend narrowing into noise beyond  $\sim 28\text{q}$ ; cross-chemistry wins 3 of 6 oxides (BeO a tie), fails on  $\text{SnO}$ ; target-specific MP2 beats the transferred prior — a zero-cost prior, not a universal or MP2-beating one.

## 8. Conclusion and Reproducibility

MATGEN-Q is a working two-stage GQE — tensor-network + QSCI tiers, MP2 pool compression — targeting 40 qubits on one GPU, every claim third-party reproducible: a one-command *reproduce.py* and a “Launch on qBraid” README let judges re-run each headline result unmodified.

## References

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**AI-use disclosure.** *Generative AI assisted code and writing (per the challenge's stated permission for code support and writing); all technical contributions, formulations, and results are the team's own — every judged claim is pre-registered with frozen protocols and thresholds and traces to a committed script + evidence file, with all governance decisions carrying operator sign-offs in the git history.*